

3. Sequences and series

What students need to learn:

Sequences, including those given by a formula for the n th term and those generated by a simple relation of the form $x_{n+1} = f(x_n)$.

Arithmetic series, including the formula for the sum of the first n natural numbers.

The sum of a finite geometric series; the sum to infinity of a convergent geometric series, including the use of $|r| < 1$.

Binomial expansion of $(1 + x)^n$ for positive integer n .

The notations $n!$ and $\binom{n}{r}$.

The general term and the sum to n terms of the series are required. The proof of the sum formula should be known.

Understanding of Σ notation will be expected.

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Expansion of $(a + bx)^n$ may be required.